

**Good guy internet**

Sometimes the internet is good - just like it was to this 8 year old with a love for bugs.
<http://dgit.in/8buglover>

**Fridge food delivery**

Walmart is testing a delivery service that puts food directly in your fridge.
<http://dgit.in/WalmartFTF>



The Resurgence of Android One

Android One is making a huge comeback this year and Agent001 has a few wise words to help Google get things rolling for good.

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G

oogle's Android One programme started out with the intention of giving customers in the developing

markets a plain vanilla experience with guaranteed updates straight from Google for years to come. The Android One programme had three phones when it launched - the Micromax Canvas A1, Karbonn Sparkle V and Spice Mi-498. Roughly three years have passed since then and we hardly get to hear about these phones, let alone the brands themselves. The three models were priced at ₹4,999 with the Sparkle being the lone exception. It had a higher price tag. And at the time of its launch, majority of smartphone sales (70-80%) were in this particular price bracket. Yet the Android One programme wasn't a suc-

Spice Mi-498 turned out to be just three more budget smartphones which were destined to have a very short shelf life and product recall, just like every other Android smartphone out there. The average consumer didn't know that with regular updates straight from Google, they'd be experiencing the newest set of features for the upcoming two years. Because even if the companies themselves might have stopped promoting Android One devices, Google sure didn't stop pushing updates. And now, with the second wave of Android One devices, Google seems to be walking down the same path.

So what should Google be doing this time around? Well, let's begin by looking at the market leaders right now. It's Samsung at the top like always, then there's Xiaomi, Vivo, Oppo and Lenovo. And now for the devices, the first Android One device in the second wave comes from Xiaomi as the Mi A1, another one is rumoured to be a Moto X4 variant. And last we heard, even HTC is entering the game with the HTC U11 Life.

There is hope for Android One this time around because instead of just one entity i.e. Google, all the participating companies have deep enough pockets to run their own marketing campaigns for long periods. This way, Google and its partners should be able



to convey the benefits of a stock experience along with guaranteed updates to the end-user. What users need to know is that opting for an Android One phone is very much similar to getting the hottest thing at any particular time since the UI is a lot cleaner and snappier and with guaranteed updates, you are better off than going with any other custom UI smartphone.

With the current generation of Android One devices, Google is not only trying to extol the benefits of stock Android to the masses but it's also targeting the hottest devices on the market. Xiaomi's Mi A1 generated more hype than any smartphone being launched in that time frame, and Motorola's Moto X4 is synonymous with the word premium. So in no way will anyone opting for these devices have the stigma of the "cheap" smartphone.

androidone

cess, monthly shipments dwindled to less than 5% in under six months of their initial launch figures. So what went wrong?

I'd say the primary issue was that Google was unable to convey the benefits of a stock Android experience to the end user. The Micromax Canvas A1, Karbonn Sparkle V and